

present. They can just reach into an ethereal space and pluck a gold coin out of their pot. Magical, isn't it?

It should come as no surprise that Google was trying to create something equally magical. With Google Drive you can create and modify your own pot of gold, and pluck stuff out of it wherever you are. Before we delve into the many features of Google Drive, we need to first understand how it works - and for that, a basic understanding of Cloud Storage is required. In simple terms, Cloud Storage is basically a system that allows user data to be stored on a remote server, and is made accessible from the internet. The servers themselves are maintained and operated by organisations such as Microsoft, Amazon, and of course, Google. Like the leprechaun, you now have access to your own goldmine of information through a click of a button. This ethereal space is called the 'cloud', and your pot of gold is data of all sorts. Whoever said modern science is incapable of magic?

A brief history of cloud storage

The modern idea of the cloud didn't originate from Google. Instead, it has evolved over time, seeing itself being modified by countless agencies, and used by even more of them. The first real technology that could be properly considered cloud computing would be the Advanced Research Projects Agency Network, or ARPANET. True to the conspiratorial belief that everything related to the internet came from the US Department of Defence, the ARPANET too started out over there in 1969. In many ways, it was the earliest predecessor to the internet as you didn't need on-site storage of computer data, and could access it remotely.

Nearly two decades before the modern concept of cloud storage and computing became mainstream, AT&T created PersonalLink. This technology allowed a virtual assistant to retrieve information about the weather, order food, and provide updates on the stock market. They based this technology out of a virtual storage area. Unfortunately, it never became popular. It would be around 2006 when the first modern version of the cloud appeared. Amazon started its Web Services (AWS) in 2002, not knowing that it will completely revolutionize the technology industry of today. By 2006, they released their S3 cloud services, and voila, we had the cloud.

While AWS was initially aimed at software developers, they soon started to target the regular internet user. Google launched its own Cloud Storage service in 2010, calling it Google Storage. By 2008, DropBox added its own name to the mix, allowing for an absolutely personal cloud storage. It was